

ARVN's remaining reserves against the NVA forces surrounding Xuan Loc, but the NVA fought them off. The NVA bombardment of Bien Hoa airbase, curtailed the South Vietnamese air force's efforts to support ground troops. With no hope of further reinforcements, the evacuation of Xuan Loc began.

The ARVN First Airborne Brigade experienced heavy losses and, when General Dao's 18th Division reached Saigon, it had lost around a third of its men. Taking responsibility for his country's military collapse, Thieu resigned his presidency on April 21, as communist troops moved in to occupy Xuan Loc. In effect, the outcome of the war had now been decided—conditions were primed for the communists to launch an assault on Saigon.



Bien Hoa airbase

Some 16 miles (26 km) outside Saigon, Bien Hoa airbase served the US and South Vietnamese air forces during the Vietnam War. It came under artillery fire during the Battle of Xuan Loc and was occupied by advancing communist troops on April 25, 1975.